PARENTING GUIDE

Raising healthy children, from newborn to teen

An interactive guide for parents. Tap any card to explore a topic, then test yourself with a short quiz.

Start exploring

Take the quiz



Pick a topic to explore

Take the quiz ›



Newborn care

The first hour



Going home early

Discharge and follow-up



Breastfeeding

Latch and milk storage



Reading aloud

Milestones from 6 months



Child protection

Spot signs, respond well



Teen guidance

The HEEADSSS check-in

Tip: use Slide Show mode so every card is clickable.

The first hour matters

Menu

1 Dry thoroughly

Immediate and thorough drying of the newborn

2 Skin to skin

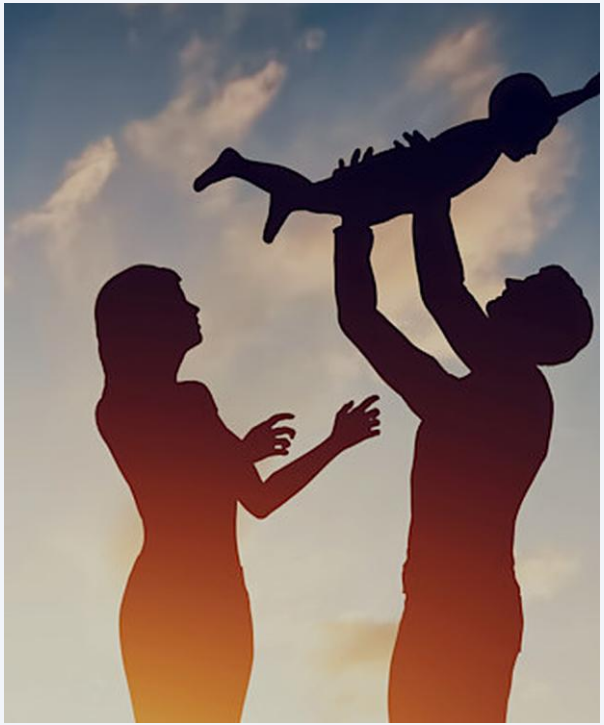
Early skin-to-skin contact between mother and baby

3 Time the cord

Properly timed cord clamping and cutting

4 Stay together

No separation of mother and baby, for early breastfeeding



Also covered before birth: rooming-in, Kangaroo Mother Care, newborn and hearing screening, Hepatitis B and BCG vaccines.

Going home early

Menu

48 hours

A newborn sent home before 48 hours needs a definite appointment, and an exam within 48 hours of discharge.

Minimum discharge criteria

- Uncomplicated pregnancy, birth and postpartum course
- Vaginal single birth at 37 weeks, stable vital signs for 12 hours
- Has urinated and passed at least one stool
- Good latch, milk transfer, swallowing and satiety
- No significant jaundice in the first 24 hours
- Parents able to care for baby; feeding education reinforced

Breastfeeding: position and latch

Menu

A good latch

- Baby’s head, back and hips in a straight line, facing the breast
- Face to face, chest to chest, tummy to tummy
- Support the breast with a C-hold
- Chin touches the breast, lower lip turned outward
- Baby takes the nipple plus about 1 inch of areola

6 months

Exclusive breastfeeding

2 years+

Keep breastfeeding, and beyond

15–30

Minutes of sucking per breast

8–10+

Feeds a day to keep milk supply up

How long can expressed milk keep?

Menu

Where it is stored	Maximum time
Room temperature, below 25°C	**4 hours**
Room temperature, above 25°C	**1 hour**
Refrigerator, 4°C	**8 days**
Freezer of a 1-door refrigerator	**2 weeks**
Freezer of a 2-door refrigerator	**3 months**
Deep freezer, constant −20°C	**6 months**



Choose the right container

Use sterile polypropylene containers (cloudy, hard plastic). Label each one with the date and time.

Read aloud, every day

Menu



Why it matters

Reading aloud builds language and literacy, so children are ready to learn and read in school.

Age	Your child	You can
6–12 mo	Turns pages with help	Point to and name pictures
12–18 mo	Sits without support; stops mouthing books	Respond when your child asks to read
18–24 mo	Turns board-book pages; names pictures	Link books to daily life; offer crayons and paper
3 yrs+	Handles books well; enjoys longer stories	Ask “What’s happening?”

Protecting children from harm

Menu

1

Learn the facts

Most offenders are family, friends or neighbors. Boys are abused almost as often as girls.

2

Reduce risk

Limit one-adult, one-child situations, where over 80% of cases happen.

3

Talk about it

Teach children which parts of their body others should not touch.

4

Know the signs

Withdrawal, unexplained anger, fear of a person, or a sudden drop in school.

If a child tells you: believe them, thank them for the courage to tell, let them talk without leading questions, and seek professional help. Child Protection Units are at PGH, PCMC and East Avenue Medical Center.

Teens: the HEEADSSS check-in

Menu



Use it at every annual visit, then counsel on healthy lifestyle, sexual behavior and STI risk, and injury prevention.

H
Home

E
Education and employment

E
Eating

A
Activities, media

D
Drugs, alcohol, tobacco

S
Sexuality

S
Suicidality, depression

S
Safety

S
Strength, spirituality

QUICK QUIZ

Test what you learned

4 questions. Tap an answer to see if you got it right. Wrong answer? You can try again.

Start quiz

Menu



Question 1 of 4

Menu

EARLY DISCHARGE

A newborn is discharged less than 48 hours after delivery. What should happen next?

A No visit is needed until the 6-week check

B A check-up within 48 hours of discharge

C A visit after one month

Correct!



A check-up within 48 hours of discharge

Early-discharge babies need a definite appointment and an exam within 48 hours of discharge.

Menu

Next question ›

Not quite



Hint

Think about how soon an early-discharged baby needs to be seen again.

Menu

Try again

Question 2 of 4

Menu

BREASTFEEDING

How long can expressed breast milk be kept in a refrigerator at 4°C?

A 4 hours

B 3 months

C 8 days

Correct!



8 days

Refrigerator (4°C): up to 8 days. Room temperature below 25°C: 4 hours. Freezer of a 2-door fridge: 3 months.

Menu

Next question ›

Not quite



Hint

Fridge storage is measured in days, not hours or months.

Menu

Try again

Question 3 of 4

Menu

BREASTFEEDING

Which describes a good breastfeeding position?

A Tummy to tummy, chest to chest, face to face

B Baby on their back, head turned away

C Only the tip of the nipple in the mouth

Correct!



Tummy to tummy, chest to chest, face to face

Baby’s head, back and hips are aligned and facing the breast: face to face, chest to chest, tummy to tummy.

Menu

Next question ›

Not quite



Hint

Baby should face the breast, fully turned toward the mother.

Menu

Try again

Question 4 of 4

Menu

CHILD PROTECTION

A child tells you that someone has been hurting them. What do you do first?

A Wait and see if it happens again

B Believe the child and thank them for the courage to tell

C Ask many detailed questions to confirm the story

Correct!



Believe the child and thank them for the courage to tell

Believe the child, thank them, let them talk without leading questions, and seek professional help.

Menu

Finish ›

Not quite



Hint

Start with trust and gratitude. Avoid leading questions.

Menu

Try again

WELL DONE

Small habits, big futures

- Start strong: dry, skin to skin, stay together
- Use a good latch, store milk safely
- Read aloud every day
- Always believe a child who tells you

Back to menu

Retake quiz

